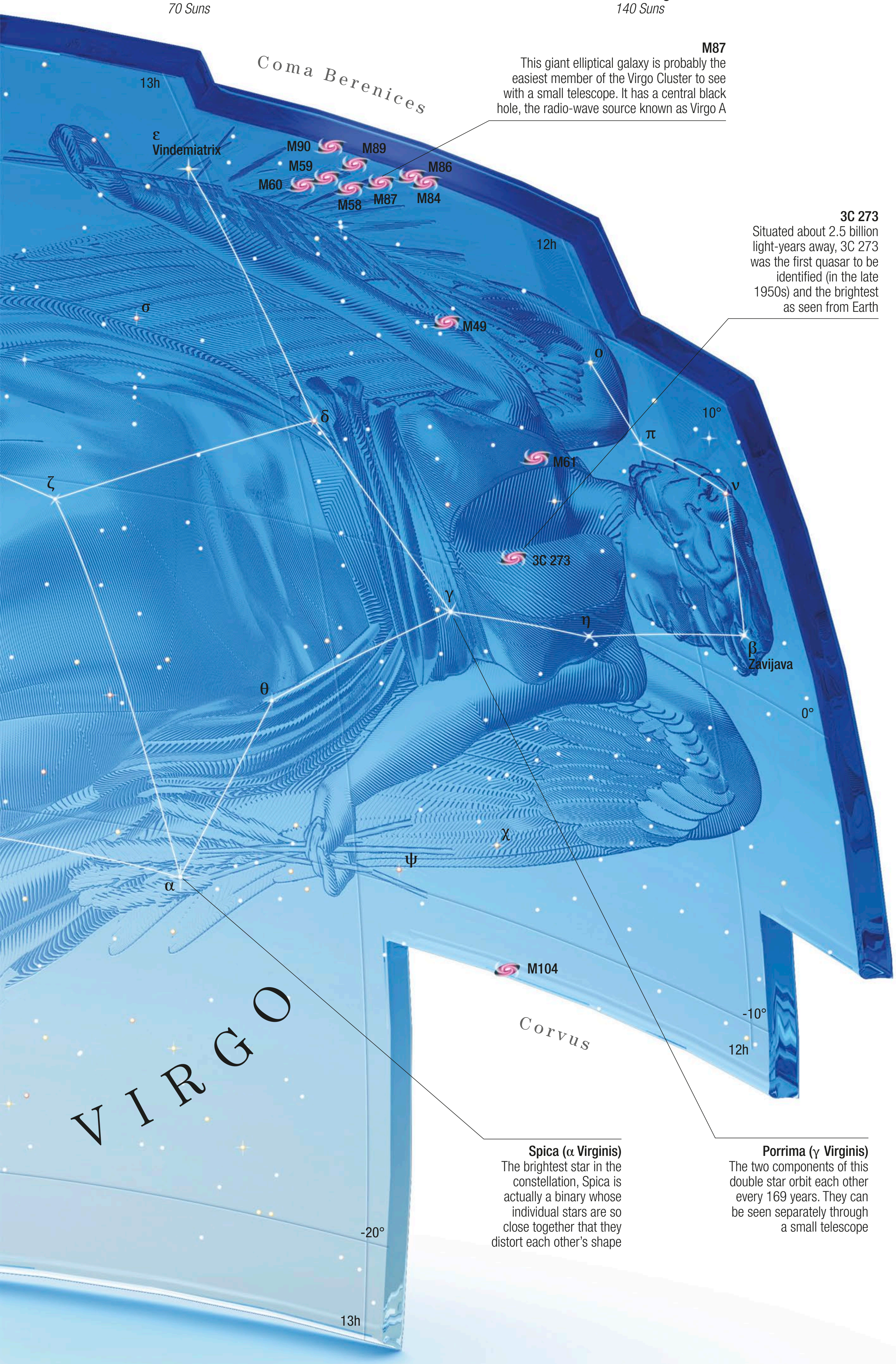
Vindemiatrix
70 Suns

Delta Virginis
140 Suns

Spica
2,070 Suns



M87
This giant elliptical galaxy is probably the easiest member of the Virgo Cluster to see with a small telescope. It has a central black hole, the radio-wave source known as Virgo A

3C 273
Situated about 2.5 billion light-years away, 3C 273 was the first quasar to be identified (in the late 1950s) and the brightest as seen from Earth

Spica (α Virginis)
The brightest star in the constellation, Spica is actually a binary whose individual stars are so close together that they distort each other's shape

Porrima (γ Virginis)
The two components of this double star orbit each other every 169 years. They can be seen separately through a small telescope

KEY DATA

Size ranking 2

Brightest stars Spica (α) 1.0, Porrima (γ) 2.7

Genitive Virginis

Abbreviation Vir

Highest in sky at 10pm April–June

Fully visible 67°N–75°S

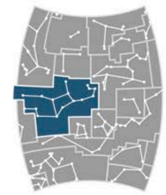


CHART 5

MAIN STARS

Spica Alpha (α) Virginis
Blue-white giant binary with a period of about 4 days
1.0 ⟷ 250 light-years

Zavijava Beta (β) Virginis
White main-sequence star
3.6 ⟷ 36 light-years

Porrima Gamma (γ) Virginis
Binary visible with a small telescope; period 169 years
2.7 ⟷ 38 light-years

Delta (δ) Virginis
Red giant
3.4 ⟷ 200 light-years

Vindemiatrix Epsilon (ε) Virginis
Yellow giant
2.8 ⟷ 110 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

M49
Elliptical galaxy in the Virgo Cluster

M58
Barred spiral galaxy in the Virgo Cluster

M59
Elliptical galaxy in the Virgo Cluster

M60
Elliptical galaxy in the Virgo Cluster

M61
Spiral galaxy in the Virgo Cluster

M84
Elliptical galaxy in the Virgo Cluster

M86
Elliptical galaxy in the Virgo Cluster

M87
Giant elliptical galaxy in the Virgo Cluster

M90
Spiral galaxy in the Virgo Cluster

Sombrero Galaxy (M104)
Edge-on spiral galaxy

3C 273
The optically brightest quasar in the sky